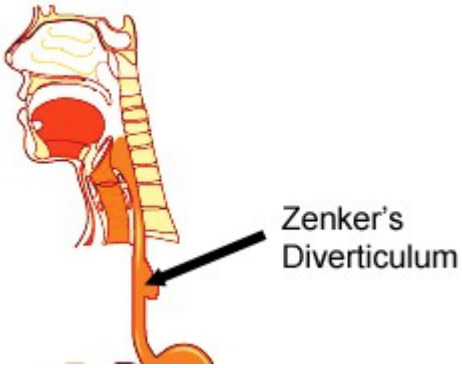
Zenker's diverticulum is a herniation of the mucosa through the posterior hypopharyngeal wall. Patients experience dysphagia, coughing, and regurgitation of undigested food as a result. Weight loss and aspiration pneumonia are seen in the mores severe cases. If the diverticulum is positioned above the cricoid cartilage, cricoid pressure becomes useless as a tactic for reducing the risk of aspiration. Rapid sequence intubation is always indicated.



Jaffe RA, Samuels SI. Anesthesiologist's Manual of Surgical Procedures. 4th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams and Wilkins, 2009: 191.

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